

Ordinance/Act:

The Uttar Pradesh State Open School Board (UPSOSB) was established by the Government of Uttar Pradesh under the Uttar Pradesh State Open School Board Act, 2008 (Act No. 27 of 2008).

The Act was enacted to create an alternative educational platform for those learners who, due to various social, economic, geographic, or personal reasons, could not pursue formal schooling. UPSOSB functions as an autonomous educational institution, responsible for planning and managing open and distance learning systems across the state.

Purpose of the Act The primary aim of the UPSOSB Act, 2008 is to:

- Promote a flexible, inclusive, and quality-driven school-level education system in Uttar Pradesh.
- Offer an academic platform to school dropouts, working youth, women, persons with disabilities, and economically weaker sections.
- Deliver services effectively through a state-wide network of study centres and regional centres.
- Promote lifelong learning as a right and tool for empowerment.

Key Powers Granted under the Act Under the Act, UPSOSB is empowered to:

1. Design and develop curricula for Secondary (Class 10) and Senior Secondary (Class 12) education.
2. Conduct public examinations and issue recognized certificates to successful learners.
3. Develop self-learning materials in print, audio, video, and digital formats.
4. Collaborate with national and international agencies to improve the quality of education.
5. Establish and operate a network of study centres and regional centres.
6. Regulate, supervise, and coordinate distance education activities across the state.
7. Ensure equal, accessible, and inclusive education for all learners without discrimination.

Autonomy and Policy Independence UPSOSB functions as an autonomous body, with the authority to define its own operational policies, academic structures, and administrative rules. The Board is empowered to innovate and adopt modern practices, including digitization, multilingual content development, and technology-based learning.

It works in coordination with the State Government and various educational institutions to expand educational reach across all sections of society.

Impact on Learners This Act has created a second chance for thousands of learners who were excluded from the formal education system. By ensuring flexible and accessible education, the Act promotes literacy, empowerment, and social inclusion, fulfilling the constitutional vision of Education for All.